

Secure Authentication Standard

Technical standard | STD-IAM-004

Document owner	Head of Identity Engineering
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Applicable reference	Annex A.8.5 - Secure authentication

Access model

Northstar Commerce uses the Access Control Policy and its information classification rules to determine authentication strength. Public information may use standard customer authentication; internal systems require managed workforce identities; restricted production and customer-data systems require phishing-resistant multi-factor authentication for administrators and privileged operators.

Workforce and privileged access

Workforce access is federated through the identity provider using FIDO2 security keys or platform passkeys plus device posture checks. Password-only login is disabled for production, VPN, source control, and cloud consoles. Break-glass accounts are stored in the privileged access vault, require two-person approval, and generate an alert on every use. Session timeout and reauthentication requirements follow the system risk tier.

Services and exceptions

Service identities authenticate with short-lived workload tokens issued by the workload identity platform. Static secrets are prohibited for new integrations and legacy exceptions require an owner, compensating control, expiry date, and quarterly review. Authentication failures and factor changes are forwarded to the security monitoring service for investigation.

Operations

Identity Engineering reviews authentication policy mappings quarterly and after a material access-control change. The March 2026 review confirmed coverage for 100 percent of production applications in the service catalog.